

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



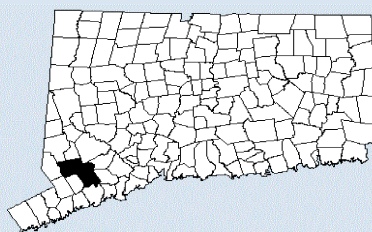
Regional School District 09

Jason Mckinnon, Superintendent • 203-261-2513 • <http://www.er9.org>

District Information

Grade Range	9-12
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	749
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$30,608
Total Expenditures ¹	\$24,608,619

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	363	48.5	48.3
Male	386	51.5	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.2
Asian	36	4.8	5.2
Black or African American	18	2.4	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	70	9.3	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	31	4.1	4.7
White	594	79.3	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	96	12.8	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	118	15.8	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	73	20.1	*	*
Male	51	13.4	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*	0	0.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	18	25.7	*	*
White	96	16.3	*	*
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	24	25.3	*	*
Students with Disabilities	36	35.6	9	7.3
District	124	16.6	12	1.6
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 35

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	55.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	4.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	10.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	3.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	1.0
School Level	8.2
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	0.0
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	3.9
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	9.5
School Nurses	1.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	87.9

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.4
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	3	3.3	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	89	96.7	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	9.4	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	9	*	13	*
White	82	54.3	131	82.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	10	*	24	82.8
Students with Disabilities	11	55.0	20	80.0
District	105	54.4	164	82.8
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*
Emotional Disability	12	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	32	82.1
Other Health Impairment	34	75.6
Other Disabilities	0	0
Speech/Language Impairment	*	*
District	84	67.2
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	13	1.7	2.6
Emotional Disability	17	2.2	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	39	5.0	6.4
Other Health Impairment	45	5.8	3.5
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	*	*	2.0
All Disabilities	125	16.0	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	8	6.4	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	11	8.8	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$15,420,782	\$19,180	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$1,189,438	\$1,549	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$487,498	\$635	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$431,351	\$562	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$1,365,895	\$1,779	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$413,383	\$538	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$3,270,539	\$4,259	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$2,030,272	\$2,620	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$-539	\$-1	\$213
Total	\$24,608,619	\$30,608	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$1,801,762	28.3	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$144,737	2.3	10.2
Other Salaries	\$258,384	4.1	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$526,661	8.3	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$288,379	4.5	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$2,506,400	39.4	22.2
Supplies	\$8,956	0.1	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$793,564	12.5	8.4
Equipment	\$38,836	0.6	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$6,367,678	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		25.9	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	95.0
State	2.9
Federal	2.0
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	12	*	12	*	12	*
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	18	*	18	*	18	*
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	*	*	*	*	*	*
White	145	68.1	145	64.8	145	84.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*	*	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	16	*	16	*	16	*
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	169	68.0	169	65.5	169	84.1
Students with Disabilities	15	*	15	*	16	*
Students without Disabilities	170	70.2	170	66.9	169	86.9
High Needs	31	54.3	31	49.7	32	66.1
Non-High Needs	154	70.5	154	67.7	153	87.5
District	185	67.7	185	64.7	185	83.8

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	N/A	N/A	N/A	79.4	175	79.4
Curl Up	N/A	N/A	N/A	88.1	176	88.1
Push Up	N/A	N/A	N/A	81.1	175	81.1
Mile Run/PACER	N/A	N/A	N/A	65.9	170	65.9
All Tests - District	N/A	N/A	N/A	47.6	170	47.6
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	N/A	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	12	*
White	172	94.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	27	88.9
Students with Disabilities	41	75.6
District	201	94.5
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	145	70.7
Male	120	64.5
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	21	56.8
White	214	69.0
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	30	63.8
Students with Disabilities	6	13.3
District	265	67.8
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	93.1	96.8
Male	83.7	89.4
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	88.4	94.1
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	73.1	100.0
Students with Disabilities	73.5	84.6
District	88.6	93.3
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	67.7	75	135.5	150	90.3	63.9
	High Needs Students	54.3	75	108.6	150	72.4	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	64.7	75	129.4	150	86.3	60.2
	High Needs Students	49.7	75	99.5	150	66.3	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	83.8	75	100.0	100	100.0	61.8
	High Needs Students	66.1	75	88.1	100	88.1	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	.	100%	.	.	.	58.7%
	High Needs Students	.	100%	.	.	.	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	.	100%	.	.	.	61.4%
	High Needs Students	.	100%	.	.	.	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	58.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	16.6%	<=5%	26.8	50	53.5	17.7%
	High Needs Students	28.1%	<=5%	3.8	50	7.6	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	68.8%	75%	45.9	50	91.7	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	67.8%	75%	45.2	50	90.4	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		99.4%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		94.5%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		90.7%	94%	96.5	100	96.5	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		88.6%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		94.5% 47.6%	75%	31.8	50	63.5	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		64.7%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	55.0%
Accountability Index				1210.9	1450	83.5	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	70.5	54.3	16.2	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	67.7	49.7	18.0	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	66.1	8.9	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	90.7%	3.3%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	96.9
	High Needs Students	83.8
Math	All Students	96.9
	High Needs Students	83.8
Science	All Students	96.9
	High Needs Students	86.5

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: N/A

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

ER9 has a tri-district improvement plan with three overarching focus areas. In order for teaching and learning to take hold, we believe in coherence among the three districts and five buildings. To that end, each school has a School Improvement Plan (SIP). This year, there are three areas of focus: 1) Teachers will focus on six of John Hattie's High Impact Teaching Strategies, including intellectual risk-taking, learning intentions, modeling and visualization, feedback, higher order thinking questions, and scaffolding content level progression; 2) standardized and nonstandardized measures of student achievement; and 3) family engagement and school climate.

Ensuring our families are well-informed and are a part of our school community is very important to us and to our students. The District's recent School Improvement Plan has highlighted efforts and measurable goals to assure families feel connected and have a sense of belonging to the school community. Through the use of actionable data from the climate survey, outreach activities for rising 9th grade students and families, special education seminars, and efforts to support and sustain a positive school climate. Parents have access to their child's academic record through PowerSchool, as well as teachers' webpages and Google classrooms.

Student attendance is carefully monitored in accordance with the State Board of Education guidelines and efforts are embedded in the aforementioned School Improvement Plan to reduce chronic absenteeism. When required, meetings are conducted with the student, parent, counselor, school social worker, and an administrator to devise a plan of action to address attendance concerns.

Joel Barlow High School has an active network of parent involved organizations such as the PTSA and booster clubs supporting our sports teams and theater program. Additionally, the Region 9 administration has extended outreach to parent groups from the two sending districts, Easton and Redding to talk about students' transition to high school. Additionally, we have initiated an 8th/9th grade dance to help connect students and bridge the transition to high school. Region 9 provides students with identified disabilities direct support through their individual education plans which allow them to develop and implement appropriate transition plans for their post-secondary education and career goals. Our in-district Life Skills program continues to provide direct individual instruction in functional academics, communication, daily living skills, and social skills. Students have the opportunity to develop their vocational skills through Work Study in the school building or in the community. Our Unified Sports Program had a successful basketball season with several games and tournaments throughout the season. Best Buddies continues to welcome students during the activity period.

Social and emotional interventions support some students through the Bridge classroom with dedicated staff. This year we offered a variety of parent forums (e.g. CT SEDS Parent Informational, Transition Planning for Life After High School, Long-Range Planning for Your Child with Special Needs). Our Mental Health First Aid trainer has provided opportunities for students, parents, and staff to receive this training. Parent coffees offer another opportunity for involvement.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Regional School District #9, Joel Barlow High School, works to reduce ethnic, racial, and economic isolation through a variety of programs. As of October 1, 2023, fourteen students from the towns of Easton and Redding attend the Fairchild Wheeler Interdistrict Magnet School in Bridgeport. Eight students, currently enrolled at Barlow, attend the Regional Center for the Arts program as part of their academic day. Two students attend the Center for Global Studies in Norwalk, six students attend the Trumbull Agriscience School, two students at Abbott Tech in Danbury, and eight students attend the Academy of Information Technology and Engineering in Stamford. Cooperative Educational Services facilitates the Open Choice Program. Students living in Bridgeport apply and are chosen from a lottery to attend Easton schools and Barlow through the Project Choice program. This year seven students participated in the program. Our faculty, working through the curriculum, and extracurricular activities, provides many opportunities for our students to interact with students throughout the region, the state, and beyond. A significant number of students participate in debate tournaments, interacting with students from Boston, Danbury, Fairfield, New Haven, Stamford and other diverse communities. Our tri-district administrative council have been working closely with a consultant from the Great Schools Partnership on Restorative Practices, cultural awareness, and understanding the unintentional harms of exclusion. The consultant has presented to the staff at Professional Development days and collaborated with our student leaders.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Allocation of resources is determined through an annual process of developing each school's operating budget in the district. Budgetary decisions are guided by the district's strategic commitment to academic excellence, character education, personalized learning and community involvement. Teachers provide input to their principals who work collaboratively with the Director of Finance that reflects each school's mission. The budget is proposed publicly at meetings conducted by the Board of Education, where members of the public are invited to provide input. Allocation of resources is discussed at monthly Board of Education meetings. Expenditures are balanced to sustain all academic and non-academic programs and determined in a manner that ensures full participation by members of the staff and full transparency to the community.